

Drupal

Drupal has enjoyed a (rather unfathomable) distinction for being the most 'developer-friendly CMS'. For quite some time, working in Drupal meant living without ready-made tools such as WYSIWYG editors to aid you—if you were using Drupal, you were hand-coding each and every element of your website, period. In other words, if you were using Drupal, you were actually employing one of the most complex tools on the Internet to build a website!

However, with the advent of Drupal 7, this has changed. Now Drupal, too, is as user-friendly as a CMS can be. Modules such as Panels, Webform and Views make website creation very simple for the end user, and such features are expected to progress even further in upcoming releases.

On the downside, Drupal can't beat WordPress when it comes to user-friendliness, and this is one of the main reasons why WP is winning converts. Unlike WP (which is run mostly by a small group of developers), Drupal is more of a framework CMS nurtured by a large community of developers. Therefore, Drupal grows as developers fix/create things that matter most to them. The plus point is the loyal community that is always willing to give back to Drupal. On the negative side, more often than not, a newbie to Drupal is greeted by the, *"if you don't find/like it, please feel free to contribute,"* syndrome.

Joomla!

Joomla! is another amazing CMS that powers many websites, and is in active development. The name 'Joomla' means for 'all together' (in Swahili), and the CMS does live up to its name. If WP is ideal for newbies and Drupal for developers, Joomla! attempts to cater to end users, designers and developers alike. The CMS is flexible and customisable, and boasts of a large community, as well as numerous extensions and templates.

With each release, Joomla! has shown a steady pace of development. However, there is still a long way to go, in comparison to WordPress or even Drupal. For instance, when it comes to out-of-the-box SEO, Joomla! lags behind Drupal. While the admin panel lets you do virtually everything—from publishing articles to sending newsletter emails, running a big website with Joomla! can get confusing.



Figure 1: wp-article



Figure 2: drupal-article



Figure 3: joomla-article

Also, from a developer's perspective, Joomla! is not the first choice for a CMS any more. While Joomla! does have its share of talented developers using it, personally, all developers that I have seen using Joomla! swear at it in frustration at some point of time. The community too, though huge, mostly comprises relatively newer users figuring out how to get that particular thing done in Joomla!

The implementation

To further illustrate the usability and modus operandi of each CMS, let us perform a simple task using each one of them—posting an article to the website.

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